241/1

HISTORY AND POLITICAL

EDUCATION

Paper 1

AUGUST 2026

2 ¼ Hours

UNNASE MOCK EXAMINATIONS

Uganda Certificate of Education

HISTORY AND POLITICAL EDUCATION

Paper 1

2 Hours 15 Minutes

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES:

This paper consists of **two** *sections* **A** *and* **B.** *It has* **four** *examination items.*

Section **A** *is compulsory.*

Answer **one** *item from Section* ***B.***

Answer **three** *examination items in all.*

*Any additional item***(s)** *answered will* **not** *be scored.*

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SECTION A

Answer **all** *items in this section.*

Item 1.

Understanding the past is not just about remembering dates. It requires checking facts, questioning stories, and using different sources throughout history, nations have used lessons from the past to plan for the future and avoid repeating old mistakes. This is what helped countries rebuild after the World Wars and during the movement for independence in Africa in the 1960s.

Today, Science and Technology are highly valued across the world. It is widely believed that people with science backgrounds are the ones who drive development. Because of this, in countries like Uganda, most parents want their children to study Medicine, Engineering, or Information Communication Technology (ICT) rather than Arts subjects. Subjects like History and Political education are often looked down upon, even though they teach leadership, citizenship, and how societies work. This has led to misunderstandings at home, where parents and children argue over subject choices.

Task:

Your school has identified you to give a talk to parents during the Annual School Parents' meeting to help them understand the importance of your subjects. You are required to:

(a) Explain how History and Political Education experts gather and confirm historical facts.
(b) Discuss the role of History and Political Education in national development.

Item 2.

During the colonial period in Uganda from 1894-1962 the British introduced Indirect Rule. Under this system the Colonial government ruled through traditional leaders like Kings, Chiefs and clan heads. The British argued that this system was cheap, preserved African culture and maintain law and order. However, it also created divisions between chiefs and common people. It also favoured some ethnic groups over others in terms of Education and economic development. One of the areas of neglect was Northern Uganda.

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During Presidential campaigns in Uganda, one presidential candidate told voters during a rally in Gulu District, that the social and economic problems in Northern Uganda today are similar to those under colonial rule, where some areas were developed and others neglected depending on administrative policy. He promised that if elected President, he would use local leaders and community structures just like the colonialists did but to serve people better. His statement confused many Voters who did not understand the link between colonial policies and today's problems. You have been asked by the District Education officer to go to the rally and explain the historical background to the people.

Task:

(a) If the presidential candidate was right, describe the situation in Northern Uganda during campaign period.
(b) Drawing lessons from colonial administrative policies, suggest methods the next President of Uganda can adopt to improve the social and economic conditions in the country.

SECTION B

Respond to **one** *item from this section.*

Item 3.

Uganda celebrates its Independence Day every 9th October, marking the country's freedom from British colonial rule in 1962. As the nation prepares to celebrate another Independence Day, some Ugandans question whether the country is fully independent. They argue that although Uganda achieved political independence, many citizens continue to face serious social and economic challenges.

These challenges include widespread poverty, unemployment, poor healthcare services, inadequate education, corruption, rising public debt, poor infrastructure, and the high cost of living. Agriculture, the backbone of Uganda's economy, continues to suffer from low productivity due to limited support, while industrial growth has remained slow. Other Ugandans believe the country has remained under indirect foreign control, making the celebration meaningless.

They argue that true independence should go beyond freedom from colonial rule and include economic self-reliance, social justice, good governance, and improved living standards for all citizens.

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Task

You have been asked by your District to speak to the public at the District Headquarters about life in Uganda since independence.

Your report should explain:

(a) With examples, manifestation of indirect influence referred to in the scenario.
(b) The efforts made by different Ugandans to solve these problems.

Item 4.

After gaining independence in the 1960s, African leaders formed the Organization of African Unity (OAU) in 1963 to promote unity and cooperation among African countries. In 2002, the OAU was replaced by the African Union (AU), which was given a wider role of promoting economic integration, democracy, peace, and solving Africa's social and economic challenges.

Today, the African Union is implementing its long-term development plan, Agenda 2063: **"The Africa We Want."** This plan focuses on key goals such as peace and security, good governance and democracy, the Silencing the Guns initiative, the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA), regional integration, industrial development, youth empowerment, women's empowerment, climate change, and Pan-Africanism, among other goals.

During a regional development forum in East Africa, some youth and community leaders criticized the African Union, saying it has not done enough to solve Africa's problems. Some even suggested that their countries should withdraw from the AU, arguing that it mainly benefits political leaders and elites. However, many of the participants did not fully understand the political, financial, and institutional challenges that limit the AU's ability to carry out its work effectively.

Tasks:

a) Explain the achievements of the African Union (AU) in implementing any six key goals mentioned in the scenario in East Africa.
b) Explain the challenges being faced by the African goals AU in implementing those goals.

END

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